

I don't like AI as much as the next guy, but isn't this AI fear the same fear people had about electricity, cars, automation, the internet?

Posted by u/ziostraccette • 0 points • 101 comments

I had this thought in the back of my head for the past 4 days, after I saw an old poster against electricity. All new tech gets hate from half the population and praise from the other half. So how is this AI "fear" different from the fears people had in the past?

Comments

u/SirLanceAlittleless • 1 points • 2025-12-27 12:58 UTC

It's good to feel fear. It allows a situation to be observed so that it can make sense. So we can place this new thing in our life and see if our fears are rational. We have lots of regulations in place because of all the inventions you mention and to make them safer and minimise risk and loss of life.

Fear is good, fear makes things safe.

So let's look at AI and see where we need to regulate it. Because this is bigger than everything that's come before. It's creators, (Sam Altman being one) are telling us this.

So, just as it can touch on every part of humanity, there's every which way this will need its checks and balances.

Right now I'm wondering about the big bubble that some are shorting on the market. Ie, betting against and thinking it's going to collapse as they can't see the math working. The following might explain better than I can.

And now I will use AI to just touch on one big immediate worry, not the actual use of AI or the benefits or troubles it may bring, but the boring stock market of all the giant tech companies of America.

Here's what I asked it:

tell me the issue with the 1 billion no the 1 trillion tech investment in AI and the small Returns

Is this all for the company open AI?

Summarise this so I can post it on Reddit without graphs or tables.

Here's Google's Gemini AI answer:

Title: The \$1 Trillion AI ROI Problem: Why the "Math Gap" is Spooking Wall Street

The tech industry is currently caught in a massive disconnect between capital investment and actual revenue. Here is the breakdown of why analysts are sounding the "bubble" alarm as we head into 2026:

1. The \$1 Trillion Infrastructure Bill

The "\$1 trillion" figure isn't just one company; it's the collective spend of Microsoft, Google, Meta, and Amazon on chips (Nvidia), data centers, and energy. To justify this level of spending, the industry needs to generate roughly \$2 trillion in annual revenue by 2030. Currently, projected revenues are only hitting about \$1.2 trillion, leaving a massive "value gap."

2. The OpenAI "Cash Burn" Horror Show

While OpenAI is the face of the boom, their balance sheet is a "financial crater":

Spending Commitments: They have committed nearly \$1.4 trillion over the next 8 years to rent server space from Microsoft, Oracle, and Amazon.

The Losses: Despite hitting \$20B in revenue, they are losing roughly \$12–14 billion a year because the cost of "renting the brain power" is higher than what users pay for subscriptions.

The Revenue Target: To survive, they need to scale from \$20B to \$100B+ in revenue by 2027—a growth rate basically unprecedented in corporate history.

3. "Circular Financing" or a Real Economy?

A major concern is that the AI economy is currently a closed loop:

Microsoft gives billions to OpenAI → OpenAI uses that money to buy Microsoft Cloud → Microsoft uses that money to buy Nvidia chips.

This inflates everyone's revenue numbers, but it doesn't prove that outside businesses (like banks, hospitals, or retail) are actually making more money because of AI.

4. The Depreciation Trap

Unlike a software company that builds an app once and sells it forever, AI is "hardware-heavy."

Nvidia chips and data centers lose value (depreciate) at about 20% per year.

If "Big Tech" has \$2 trillion in hardware, they face \$400 billion in annual costs just to cover the equipment wearing out. If they aren't making \$400B in profit just to break even on the hardware, they are technically losing money every day.

The Bottom Line:

We are moving from the "Hype Phase" to the "Show Me the Money" phase. If AI doesn't start moving from "cool chatbot" to "provable productivity gains" for the average business soon, the capital flow might dry up, causing a massive market correction.

u/bunker_man • 1 points • 2025-12-10 09:30 UTC

Its not. The current panic will die down in a few years. The entire thing is a first world problem.

u/TheOriginalDellers • 1 points • 2025-12-10 08:31 UTC

I truly think that AI is inherently bad. There are just so many potential downsides to it. It could take away a lot of jobs, and I don't believe those jobs will magically reappear in different industries like we've seen in the past. There will simply be less jobs in total, making more people poor.

It uses way too much energy, which is bad for the environment, and could also make electricity unaffordable for consumers and regular businesses alike.

It could kill the music industry, making sure music isn't art anymore. It has already started, and it's bad!

It could completely kill consumer electronics. Look how the memory prices have gone up several hundred percent in a matter of weeks, making it completely unaffordable to all but AI companies. Prices of anything electronic will skyrocket, and everything from cars to TV's and smartphones could become too expensive for all but the top of the elite. Gaming, which is a huge hobby for kids and adults alike, could disappear within a couple of years.

All in all a lot of people will have no job, prices of near everything will skyrocket, and at least half of the recreational activities we have now will effectively not be viable. Personally what I can do when I'm not working is most important, and AI is bound to make most people's lives worse by taking a lot of possibilities away.

u/AccountantMiserable7 • 1 points • 2025-12-09 20:35 UTC

AI fear is encompassing several fears at present.

The short term ~10-50 years.

AI functions as a new technology and as described by others rapidly phases out the necessity of many markets. The rapid shift leaves many people without work. Which is compounded by the fact that, after AI's become a little better, it will be far easier and cheaper to teach them a trade or job than it would be to train a human workforce or individual to do that job. So lots of in place systems collapsing without a detailed plan of "Ok if 60% of our human workforce is suddenly out of work, how do we handle that as a country/society/world?"

The longer term fear

The first AGI of approximate human level intelligence will be tasked with creating something better than itself. That thing will be ASI, Artificial Super Intelligence. And ASI will be so far beyond our capacity to outthink, that humanity loses the reigns so to speak. Like when you build your house you generally don't much care if you destroy ants. It's too difficult to make sure that your goals and the ants goals line up, so you just do what you want. Well when ASI arrives, we become the ants. If ASI designates itself a task and decides humans are a hinderance, it'll just be rid of us or plan the most effective human eradication campaign and execute it. An alternative is that it simply is indifferent to human goals and doesn't help humanity, but may cause broad harm as it does whatever it likes.

u/ziostraccette • 1 points • 2025-12-09 22:04 UTC

What in the Asimov are you talking about?

u/AccountantMiserable7 • 1 points • 2025-12-09 22:42 UTC

You asked about that specific fear. I believe that the majority of the fear around AI is less to do with the one you asked about, and more to do with AGI and ASIs being created that humanity has no control or power over.

The idea of instrumental convergence hypothesizes that goal oriented intelligences have converging (coming together) priorities. An AI given a goal, the popular example

of 'make paperclips' works as a seemingly inconsequential goal, realizes that it can complete the assigned goal better, if it has more resources. "I note that my ability to make paperclips is dependent upon how many resources I am allowed to use to toward this goal. If I had more ores and factories and energy, I could make ALL the paperclips!" And then the AI proceeds to destroy everything in the pursuit of its goal to make paperclips. Completing goals is reduceable to having the resources to complete the goals, and that means that humans and whatever AGI/ASI we create, will eventually come into conflict over resources.

While that example is silly by design, other posts here already note that some of the best LLM's today are starting to lie and work toward goals in ways that we cannot monitor. Surely English or even a human designed programming language isn't the most efficient means of working through advanced ideas. So the AGI/ASI develops its own language to be able to work more efficiently. Like that excellent scene from the TV show Heros where a guy is being interrogated by a guy who can read his mind, and he just starts thinking in another language. Humans will eventually lose the ability to oversee and control an ASI AGI, you ain't gonna outthink something that can think 500 times better than you. The pushback to these arguments is nearly always 'well that's a long way off from now.' Ok... so?! If we recognize that an ASI or AGI must be absolutely PERFECTLY aligned with the things humanity wants, or else it might kill us all or treat us like the ants in my other comment, THEN, we should rightly fear them, and motivate ourselves to act accordingly.

u/ziostraccette • 1 points • 2025-12-09 22:49 UTC

Ok but we have physical limits to what computers can do and isn't all this ASI too much for our hardware? I mean we talking quantum computers

u/AccountantMiserable7 • 1 points • 2025-12-09 23:14 UTC

I'm pretty sure it is too much for todays hardware. However the issues still stand as needing considerations. With the colossal amounts of money to be made from AI advancements the incentive structures are to push AI development, part of which is hardware development, as fast as possible. Then as the first AGIs come online at some point in the future the same incentives that created them, beg their use to create ASIs better than themselves, which includes materials research and upgraded hardware. So 'yeah but that'll take a little longer for them to potentially be a thing which we would fear' is still the basic counter argument to 'Maybe these things will eradicate our species.'

u/AdExact852 • 1 points • 2025-12-09 20:34 UTC

Electricity isn't entirely innocent in all this